

Intermediate Microeconomic Theory and Policy

(Econ 306)

Term: Summer Session 1 2026

Instructor: Andrew Raychawdhuri

Pronouns: He/Him

Email: araychaw@umd.edu

Office Hours:

- Tuesdays 10am-11am
- Wednesdays 4:30pm-5:30pm
- Thursdays 12pm-1pm

If these do not work, please email me for availability outside these hours.

Course Logistics

Credits: 4

Course Dates: June 1, 2026 – July 10, 2026

Course Times: 2:00pm - 4:15pm

Classroom: Online on Zoom

Prerequisites: Minimum grade of C- in ECON200 and ECON201; and 1 course with a minimum grade of C- from (MATH120, MATH130, MATH136, MATH140).

Course Description

Analysis of the theories of consumer behavior, producer behavior, different market structures, and various sources of inefficient outcomes. Analysis of microeconomic policies designed to improve market outcomes. The main subject topics covered are consumer theory (Demand), production (Supply), and competitive and non-competitive market structures. We will cover both non-strategic models (perfect competition, monopoly, monopolistic competition) as well as strategic models of imperfect competition (game theoretic models of duopoly and oligopoly).

Learning Outcomes

After successfully completing this course you will be able to:

- Solve common optimization problems to derive profit-maximizing output and utility maximizing consumption bundles.
- Understand the foundations of demand, supply, consumer and firm theory.
- Analyze different market structures using tools from game theory.

Required Resources

- **Course Website:** elms.umd.edu
- **Book:** Jeffrey Perloff Microeconomics 9ed., Pearson, New York, 2022.
- **Application/Software:** Textbook plus MyLab is required to complete Homework Assignments. This course uses digital materials delivered directly through ELMS-Canvas. This course is enrolled

in UMD's First Day Inclusive Access Program, which makes materials available at a discount and charges the cost directly to your EBill.

How to Get Started:

1. Log into this course on ELMS-Canvas.
2. Click the Course Materials link in the left-hand menu.
3. View your materials, pricing, and access options.

Billing and Opt-Out Info: The discounted cost of these materials will be charged to your Student Account after the add/drop period. If you wish to opt out, you must do so through the "Course Materials" link before the deadline. Check your UMD email for the message: "URGENT: Accessing Your Course Materials and Billing Info" for details. If you have any issues please let me know and I can direct you to the necessary resources.

Course Structure

This course has 4 live sessions via Zoom that are held each week. This is a summer course and is at an accelerated pace compared to a normal semester. As a result, it is very important to attend lecture and be on top of the weekly reading and assignments. Additionally, there will be 3 Quizzes throughout the semester during class (I will let you know the week but not what day they will be). We will be covering lots of material each week so please reach out ASAP if you fall behind since it will be difficult to get back on track if you are confused and do not reach out early. The flexible framework does not require you to be in a specific location to participate; however, you must have access to a full-screen computer or tablet for each live session. Lectures will be recorded but attendance is strongly recommended (especially since there will be Quizzes that can only be taken during class time)

Tips for Success in This Course

- **Participate.** I invite you to engage deeply, ask questions, and talk about the course content with your classmates. You can learn a great deal from discussing ideas and perspectives with your peers and professor. Participation can also help you articulate your thoughts and develop critical thinking skills.
- **Manage your time.** Students are often very busy, and I understand that you have obligations outside of this class. However, students do best when they plan adequate time devoted to course work. Block your schedule and set aside plenty of time to complete assignments, including extra time to handle any technology-related problems. This is especially important given the shortened summer session.
- **Login regularly.** I recommend that you log in to ELMS-Canvas several times a week to view any announcements and the assignments for the week.
- **Do not fall behind.** This class moves at a quick pace and each week builds on the previous content. If you feel you are starting to fall behind, check in with the instructor as soon as possible

so we can troubleshoot together.

- **Use ELMS-Canvas notification settings.** ELMS-Canvas can ensure you receive timely notifications via email or text. Be sure to enable announcements to be sent instantly or daily.
- **Ask for help if needed.** If you need help with ELMS-Canvas or other technology, contact IT Support. If you are struggling with a course concept, reach out to me and your classmates for support.

Policies and Resources

It is our shared responsibility to know and abide by the University of Maryland's policies that relate to all courses, which include topics like:

- Academic integrity
- Student and instructor conduct
- Accessibility and accommodations
- Attendance and excused absences
- Grades and appeals
- Copyright and intellectual property

Please reference and review the Office of Undergraduate Studies' Course-Related Policies and follow up with me if you have questions. These can be viewed [here](#).

Course Guidelines

Names/Pronouns and Self-Identifications

The University of Maryland recognizes the importance of a diverse student body, and we are committed to fostering inclusive and equitable classroom environments. I invite you, if you wish, to tell us how you want to be referred to in this class, both in terms of your name and your pronouns (he/him, she/her, they/them, etc.). Keep in mind that the pronouns someone uses are not necessarily indicative of their gender identity. For more information about names and gender markers, visit the LGBTQ+ Equity Center.

Additionally, it is your choice whether to disclose how you identify in terms of your gender, race, class, sexuality, religion, and dis/ability, among all aspects of your identity. I will do my best to address and refer to all students accordingly, and I ask you to do the same for all of your fellow Terps.

Video or Audio Recording

Video or audio recording of class sessions, activities, or discussions is prohibited without advance permission from the professor. Maryland is one of 11 U.S. states that require two-party, or all-party, consent before it is permissible to record or otherwise intercept and/or capture communications.

This means that everyone participating in a conversation must give their consent before any communication is recorded.

Communication with Instructor

Email: If you need to reach me, please email araychaw@umd.edu. Please do *not* email me with questions easily found in the syllabus or on ELMS (e.g., “When is this assignment due? How much is it worth?”), but please *do* reach out about personal, academic, and intellectual concerns. I will do my best to respond to emails within 24 hours but may take more time if you send an email on the weekend.

ELMS: I will send important announcements via ELMS messaging. You must ensure that your email and announcement notifications (including changes in assignments and/or due dates) are enabled in ELMS so you do not miss any messages. You are responsible for checking your email and Canvas/ELMS inbox with regular frequency.

Communication with Peers

With a diversity of perspectives and experience, we may find ourselves in disagreement and/or debate with one another. As such, it is important that we agree to conduct ourselves in a professional manner and that we work together to foster and preserve a classroom environment in which we can respectfully discuss and deliberate controversial questions. Free speech has its limits, and this course is *not* a space for hate speech, harassment, or derogatory language.

Any behavior (including harassment, sexual harassment, and racially and/or culturally derogatory language) that threatens this atmosphere will not be tolerated. Please alert me immediately if you feel threatened, dismissed, or silenced at any point during our semester together.

Major Assignments

Homework Assignments (10%)

- Weekly homework will be assigned through MyLab.
- There are 5 in total with around 20 questions each that cover the chapters we are covering in class that week.
- All are available now and due on Mondays. Check ELMS for due dates.
- You can work together and ask me for help but please do not use any AI resources. The homework is good practice for exams.

Quizzes (15%)

- 3 short Quizzes (20 minutes) during class time.
- I will let you know the week but not the day.
- Will be one hand-written question related to content we have just covered.
- Similar process for uploading as Exams.

Worksheets (15%)

- 5 worksheets in total due each week except the week of Exam 1.
- 2 will be randomly graded for accuracy while 3 are graded for completion (since Worksheet 5 is during the Exam 2 week and has a shorter timeline this will be one of the worksheets graded for completion. So two of Worksheets 1-4 will be graded for accuracy).
- You can work together and consult other resources, and me, but please do not use any AI resources. Same rules as the homework.

Exams (30% each)

- Two exams on course content. Taken in class to be proctored on Zoom (two devices will be needed).
- They will not be cumulative and will cover different parts of the course. I will let you know the topics as we approach the exam.
- You will have 1 hour and 15 minutes to complete
- Exams will be hand written and then there will be time to upload answers to ELMS for grading
- Exams will be closed book.

Grading Structure

Assignment	Percentage
Homework (5 in total)	10%
Weekly Worksheet (5 in total)	15%
Quizzes (3 in total, each worth 5%)	15%
Exam 1	30%
Exam 2	30%
Total	100%

Academic Integrity

The University's Code of Academic Integrity is designed to ensure that the principles of academic honesty and integrity are upheld. In accordance with this code, the University of Maryland does not tolerate academic dishonesty. All students are expected to adhere to this Code. As future professionals, your commitment to high ethical standards and honesty begins with your time at the University of Maryland.

Course assistance websites such as CourseHero are not permitted sources unless the instructor explicitly gives permission. Material taken or copied from these sites can be deemed unauthorized material and a violation of academic integrity.

Students may naturally choose to use online forums for course-wide discussions to discuss concepts in the course. However, collaboration on graded assignments is strictly prohibited unless otherwise

stated.

AI Policy for This Course

In this class, you may use AI tools (Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, etc.) for help in understanding course concepts, coming up with sample problems and asking for further clarification on course content.

However, AI cannot be used on any graded assignments. Your work must be completed by you independently. If you have questions on worksheets and homework, I am happy to discuss during office hours and would prefer you do that instead of simply pasting the questions into an AI chat bot.

AI is prohibited on exams and if anyone is found to have used AI on an exam or any assignment they will get a 0 on the assignment and will be reported to the Honor Council.

In general, I think AI can be a useful tool for understanding concepts and asking for clarity but **DO NOT** use it to replace actual learning and deep understanding. In this class, and beyond, you will not always be able to rely on answers given by AI and learning how to think about, and solve, complex problems on your own will be an extremely valuable skill.

See the University of Maryland guidelines on Generative AI for Teaching & Learning for more information.

Grades

All assessment scores will be posted on the course ELMS page. If you would like to review any of your grades (including exams) or have questions about how something was scored, please email me to schedule a time to meet.

Late submissions without an excused absence face a ten percentage point penalty per day late (so if the assignment is out of 20 and you turn it in a day late the best score you can get is a 90 which would be an 18/20). After seven days, late assignments will not be accepted and will be awarded a 0. If you must request an extension due to a medical emergency or anything else please email me as soon as possible so we can work on an arrangement.

I am happy to discuss any of your grades with you, and if I have made a mistake I will immediately correct it. Any formal grade disputes must be submitted in writing within one week of receiving the grade.

Final letter grades are assigned based on the percentage of total assessment points earned. I will calculate your score on each assignment as a percentage and then apply the weights above to calculate your grade as a percent out of 100. To be fair to everyone I must establish clear standards and apply them consistently, so please understand that being close to a cutoff is not the same as making the cut ($89.99 \neq 90.00$). It would be unethical to make exceptions for some and not others. Therefore, the grade cutoffs are final and there will not be any rounding done at the end of the semester. If exams are harder than I intend them to be, there may be a curve applied but that is up to my discretion. Your grade will be no lower than these cutoffs (for example, a grade of 90 or above will be at least an A-).

Final Grade Cutoffs

Grade	Cutoff	Grade	Cutoff	Grade	Cutoff	Grade	Cutoff	Grade	Cutoff
A+	97.00%	B+	87.00%	C+	77.00%	D+	67.00%	F	< 60.0%
A	94.00%	B	84.00%	C	74.00%	D	64.00%		
A–	90.00%	B–	80.00%	C–	70.00%	D–	60.00%		

Course Outline

Week	Topic	Deliverable
1 (6/1 - 6/5)	Demand and Supply (Ch 2 and 3 in Perloff)	Worksheet 1, Homework 1
2 (6/8 - 6/12)	Consumer Theory (Ch 4 and 6 in Perloff)	Worksheet 2, Quiz 1, Homework 2
3 (6/15 - 6/19)	Theory of the Firm (Ch 7 and 8 in Perloff)	Exam 1 (6/18) and Homework 3
4 (6/22 - 6/26)	Perfect Competition and Monopoly. (Ch 9 and Ch 11 in Perloff)	Worksheet 3, Quiz 2, Homework 4
5 (6/29 - 7/3)	Oligopolies and Game Theory (Ch 13 and Ch 14)	Worksheet 4, Quiz 3, Homework 5
6 (7/6 - 7/10)	Externalities (Ch 18)	Exam 2 (7/9) and Worksheet 5

*Note: This is a tentative schedule and subject to change as necessary—**monitor the course ELMS page for current deadlines**. In the unlikely event of a prolonged university closing, or an extended absence from the university, adjustments to the course schedule, deadlines, and assignments will be made based on the duration of the closing and the specific dates missed.*

Resources & Accommodations

Accessibility and Disability Services

The University of Maryland is committed to creating and maintaining a welcoming and inclusive educational, working, and living environment for people of all abilities. The Accessibility & Disability Service (ADS) provides reasonable accommodations to qualified individuals to provide equal access to services, programs, and activities. ADS cannot assist retroactively, so it is generally best to request accommodations several weeks before the semester begins or as soon as a disability becomes known. Any student who needs accommodations should contact me as soon as possible.

For assistance in obtaining an accommodation, contact Accessibility and Disability Service at 301-314-7682, or email adsfrontdesk@umd.edu.

Emergency Preparedness

Emergencies on campus can happen at any time. To prepare, visit prepare.umd.edu or use the emergency symbol in the UMD App.

Student Resources and Services

Taking personal responsibility for your own learning means acknowledging when your performance does not match your goals and doing something about it. I hope you will come talk to me so that I can help you find the right approach to success in this course, and I encourage you to visit UMD's Student Academic Support Services website to learn more about the wide range of campus resources available to you.

In particular, everyone can use some help sharpening their communication skills by visiting UMD's Writing Center.

Basic Needs Security

If you have difficulty affording groceries or accessing sufficient food to eat every day, or lack a safe and stable place to live, please visit UMD's Division of Student Affairs website for information about resources the campus offers and let me know if I can help in any way.

Veteran Resources

UMD provides additional support to student veterans. You can access those resources at the Office of Veteran Student Life and the Counseling Center. Veterans and active duty military personnel with special circumstances (e.g., upcoming deployments, drill requirements, disabilities) are welcome and encouraged to communicate these, in advance if possible, to the instructor.

Notice of Mandatory Reporting

As a faculty member, I am designated as a "Responsible University Employee," and I must report all disclosures of sexual assault, sexual harassment, interpersonal violence, and stalking to UMD's Title IX Coordinator per University Policy on Sexual Harassment and Other Sexual Misconduct.

If you wish to speak with someone confidentially, please contact one of UMD's confidential resources, such as CARE to Stop Violence (Ground Floor of the Health Center) at 301-741-3442 or the Counseling Center (Shoemaker Building) at 301-314-7651.

You may also seek assistance or supportive measures from UMD's Title IX Coordinator, Angela Nastase, by calling 301-405-1142, or emailing titleIXcoordinator@umd.edu.

Course Evaluation

Please submit a course evaluation through Student Feedback on Course Experiences in order to help faculty and administrators improve teaching and learning at Maryland. All information submitted is confidential. Campus will notify you when Student Feedback on Course Experiences is open at the end of the semester.

Copyright Notice

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